

SNIPPETS

3G services will be successful in India

The third-generation (3G) services will be hugely successful in India as there is a great demand from mobile data services in the country, according to Paul Jacobs, chairman and chief executive, Qualcomm. India provides a unique opportunity for mobile broadband service as it is a nascent market and the wireless subscribers are growing rapidly.

NEC, Hitachi, Casio may merge mobile phone operations

Japan's NEC Corp., Hitachi and Casio Computer are in talks to merge their struggling cellphone operations to cut development costs in a saturated market. If they were to merge production of phones as well as development, that could create Japan's No. 2 cellphone maker, not far behind Sharp Corp., according to industry data by research firm BCN Inc.

chairman and managing director, BSNL. "This is one of them."

Millicom International is selling its operations in Sri Lanka, Cambodia and Laos. In Sri Lanka, its Tigo network is the third-largest mobile network with a subscriber base of over two millions.

Samsung aims to sell 22 million LCD TVs

Samsung Electronics aims to cross last year's 21 million mark to fold up a sale of 22 million LCD TVs this year. It has sold 10.7 million LCD TVs during the first half of this year.

The electronics giant also aims to sell a total of two million LCD televisions with light-emitting-diode (LED) backlight technology this year. It predicts that rivalry in the LED-backlit TV market will intensify next year, with global sales likely to reach around 30 million units, and Samsung selling over 10 million.

"LED TV sales may peak in 2011 or 2012. By then, LED TVs will exceed (the conventional CCFL-backlit) LCD TVs by over 50 per cent," said Yoon Boo-keun, president, digital media and communications business, Samsung Electronics.

Nokia Booklet 3G too expensive for a netbook

Netbooks or mini notebook devices have become popular because of



Nokia Booklet 3G netbook

their low cost; the majority of them are priced below \$500 today. Besides, they are also low in weight. The new Nokia Booklet 3G netbook, featuring mobile broadband, a 12-hour battery, A-GPS support, sleek aluminium chassis and 25.4cm glass HD-ready display, may also seem like an attractive option.

However, its steep \$816 (Rs 40,000 approx.) price tag could drive customers away. They will opt for a more reasonable Acer, Asus, HP or Samsung netbook, all of which are priced between \$350 and \$500.

Nokia may have to make significant changes to the Booklet 3G functionality, or the price or both, to make a dent in the netbook market.

Acer, HP early winners in PC recovery

As the PC industry embarks on its fitful road to recovery, many are bet-

ting that Taiwan's Acer and HP will lead the rebound with surging netbook sales and a strong presence in booming Asia. These two PC makers are expected to gain from consumer demand in China, India and other resilient Asian markets, even as corporate demand stays weak in the global economic slowdown.

"Acer will more likely recover quicker because it's doing well in the pockets that it is in... it is one of the lower-cost providers out there that is still respected," said Louis Misciocia, research director, Brigantine Advisors.

TCS to hire 25,000 employees this year

Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) will hire 25,000 people globally this year, 90 per cent of which will be in India alone. Tier-II cities are its only focus for expansion in the country as the top rung are clogged and saturated. The company

also aims to raise its revenue from government projects to at least 10 per cent in the next three years. With the Indian government planning to spend Rs 400 billion on IT services, TCS is actively looking into this space for more business.

NEC Electronics, Renesas sign business integration pact

NEC Electronics Corporation, Renesas Technology Corporation, NEC Corporation, Hitachi Ltd and Mitsubishi Electric Corporation have signed an agreement to integrate business operations at NEC Electronics and Renesas.

As a condition to the business integration, Renesas will issue shares of Renesas common stock to Hitachi and Mitsubishi Electric, the sole shareholders of Renesas, at 78 billion yen. In addition, on the effective date of the business integration scheduled April 1, 2010, the integrated company will issue shares of its common stock to NEC, Hitachi and Mitsubishi Electric at about 122 billion yen.

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